

Bench Book Magistrate Wizard

— Case-Specific Workflow

Protocol Spec

Purpose

The app currently applies a single "Criminal Trial" workflow to every matter. This spec defines **classification-specific workflows** so that selecting a different matter type drives a different stage sequence, different stage labels, and different data-capture fields at the Decision stage.

1. Baseline — Criminal Trial (existing, unchanged)

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Arraignment → Custody → Disclosure →  
Trial → Ruling → Judgment → Sentence →  
Appeal → Outcome
```

No changes to this protocol. It remains the default when "Criminal Trial" is selected as the classification.

2. New Classification — Paper Committal

Trigger: Classification = "Paper Committal"

Stage sequence:

Arraignment → Custody → Disclosure →
Paper Committal → Ruling → Judgment →
Appeal → Outcome

Key differences from Criminal Trial:

- The "Trial" stage is **replaced** by a "Paper Committal" stage (label change, not just a renamed trial — this stage should not carry any trial-specific fields).
 - Paper Committal stage status options:
Commenced / Partial / Completed
- **No Sentence stage** — remove entirely for this classification (the magistrate does not pass sentence on a paper committal).
- Appeal stage is retained.
- Outcome stage: simplified to **Completed** (this is the terminal status once Judgment/Appeal steps close out).

Custody stage: field options are **Bail / Remanded**.

3. Revised Classifications — Protection Order / Maintenance / Liability Matters

Trigger: Classification = "Protection Order Matter",
"Maintenance Matter", or "Liability Matter"

These three classifications share **one workflow shape**, distinct from the criminal-style flow (no Arraignment, no Custody, no Disclosure):

Information Sworn → Summons Served →
Returns of Summons → Trial → Decision →
Outcome

Stage-by-stage detail:

1. **Information Sworn** — commencement step for the matter (equivalent to case initiation).
2. **Summons Served** — Yes/No field.
3. **Returns of Summons** — Yes/No field.
4. **Trial** — Yes/No field (a trial may or may not occur in these matter types; unlike Paper Committal, this stage keeps the "Trial" label).
 - Build in the ability to **adjourn before the trial commences** — a matter may need to be stood down so parties can bring supporting

documentation (e.g., receipts, payslips, proof of income/expenses for a child, in maintenance matters). This adjournment option should be available at each stage, not just before Trial.

5. **Decision** – the field(s) captured here depend on the classification selected:

Classification	Decision field
Protection Order Matter	Granted / Not Granted (selector)
Maintenance Matter	Amount ordered (numeric input)
Liability Matter	Amount paid (numeric input)

6. **Outcome** – Completed / Adjourned.
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4. Implementation Notes

- The workflow engine should branch on the **Classification** field selected at case creation: Criminal Trial, Paper Committal, Protection Order Matter, Maintenance Matter, Liability Matter.

- Each classification maps to its own ordered stage list and its own stage-label set (per sections 1–3 above), rather than reusing the Criminal Trial labels with conditional visibility.
- The Decision stage for Protection Order / Maintenance / Liability matters needs a **classification-aware input**: selector for Protection Order, numeric currency field for Maintenance and Liability.
- Adjournment should be modeled as a status/state available at the relevant stages (per matter type) rather than a separate stage, so the docket can show "Adjourned — awaiting documentation" without breaking the stage sequence.